

A

Relatives*

RELATIVES



My father died when I was nine, and so my mother was a **widow**¹ with four young children. She **remarried** five years later, so now I have a **stepfather**. As he is not my real father, I call him by his first name, which is Dieter. I've got an **elder**² brother called Thomas and two younger sisters, Anya and Claudia, who are **twins**³. We're a **close family**⁴.

My mother is an **only child**⁵, but I've got two uncles on my father's side. One is married with two children, and the other is married with three children, so **altogether** I have five **cousins**. I **get on well with**⁶ Uncle Rolf, and he always tells me I'm his favourite **nephew**. Of his **nieces**, I think he likes Anya best.

Recently my brother Thomas **got married**. His wife's name is Sabine, so I now have a **sister-in-law**⁷ as well.

* members of your family; *syn* **relations**

¹ a woman whose husband has died

² older

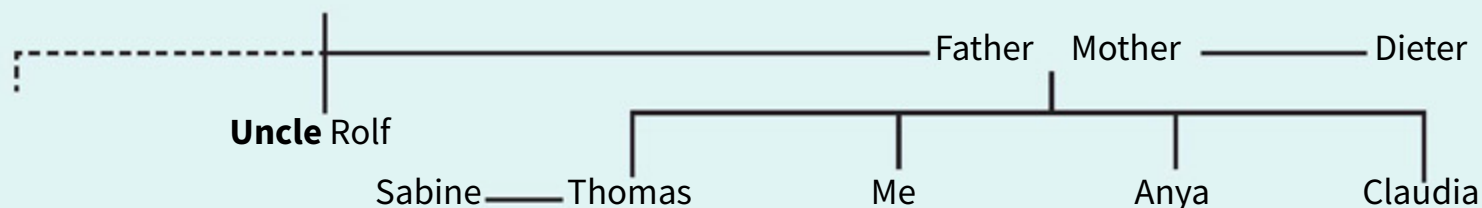
³ two children born to one mother at the same time

⁴ a family who like each other and stay together a lot

⁵ without brothers or sisters

⁶ have a good relationship with

⁷ (also **mother/brother/son-in-law**, etc.)



Common mistakes

It's more common and more natural to say '**Thomas's** wife' (NOT ~~the wife of Thomas~~) or '**Anna's** younger sister' (NOT ~~the younger sister of Anna~~).

B

Friends

FRIENDS

My **best friend** is Florian, an **old school friend**¹. We **got to know each other**² when we were in the same class at school. We've been **mates**³ **ever since**⁴, and our **friendship** is very important to both of us. He spends a lot of time with my family, and his **current**⁵ girlfriend is actually one of Thomas's **ex-girlfriends**. But we all get on really well.



Language help

We use the prefix **ex-** for a relationship we had in the past but do not have now, e.g. *The children stay with my **ex-** husband at the weekend; I saw an **ex-** girlfriend of mine yesterday.*